

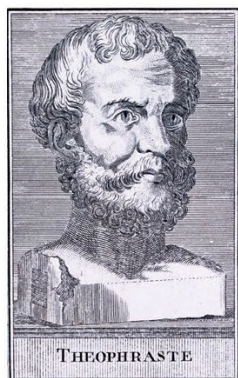


# Plant science

Although people have always relied on plants, the science of plants—known as botany—has been studied for only around 2,500 years. Early scientists described the medicinal properties of plants, while later researchers investigated them to learn how they survive and thrive.

**350 BCE**

Theophrastus, a student of the Greek philosopher Aristotle, is the first to study plants for their own sake. He writes the first botanical books, describing around 500 plants.



**1200s**

Arabian scientist Ibn al-Baytār writes the *Compendium on Simple Medicaments and Foods*, featuring the names of 1,400 plants, foods, drugs, and their uses.



*Ibn al-Baytār was one of the most influential writers on botany in medieval times.*

**1600s**

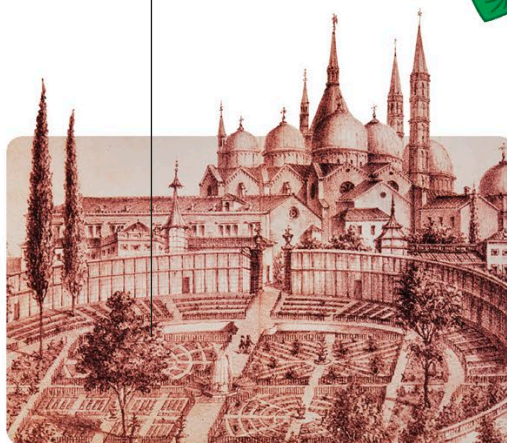
Hydroponics, a method of growing plants in a nutrient-filled liquid rather than in the soil, is first described in the 1600s. This technique can produce more food in the same space and is a popular method of growing plants today.

**60 CE**

Greek botanist Pedanius Dioscorides writes *De Materia Medica*, a book on medicinal plants, which is used for the next 1,500 years.



*The garden exists today in its original location, in Padua, Italy.*



**1545**

The world's oldest botanical garden, the *Orto Botanico di Padova*, is built. The garden was used to grow medicinal plants and teach students about them.

**1561**

The plant *Cordia sebestena* is named after German botanist Valerius Cordus. He describes plant features and medicinal properties for the first time in his book *Historia Plantarum*, published in 1561.

